

Akeso

Ad hoc HARMONi OS update: Positive but unlikely to be fundamentally needle-moving

On 22 July, Summit released an updated, but ad hoc, overall survival (OS) analysis from its global Ph3 HARMONi trial (ivonescimab + chemo vs, chemo in 2L+ EGFR-mutated non-squamous NSCLC); the trial that underpins its FDA BLA (PDUFA date Nov. 14, 2026). With longer Western follow-up and a June 2026 data cutoff, Western patients now show an OS HR of 0.76, consistent with that of the ITT (intention-to-treat) population in this global study and consistent with that of the Chinese population in the China Ph3 trial HARMONi-A. We view this as sentiment-supportive rather than fundamentally needle-moving. The updated OS HR looks decent, but because this is an ad hoc analysis outside the original statistical plan, we cannot claim it to be statistically significant or not; there is no formal p-value, just a nominal p-value with favorable trend. Safety was clean with no new signals. We remain OW on Akeso.

- **Implications for HARMONi itself — incrementally supportive of the BLA, but not decisive.** The prespecified primary OS analysis was not statistically significant (HR 0.79, p=0.057), while PFS clearly hit (HR 0.52, p<0.00001). The 22 July analysis tightens Western patients' OS HR to 0.76 and shows West/Asia convergence, helping address the two earlier concerns to some extent that 1) OS benefit was Asia-skewed; and 2) OS benefit of Asian and Western patients might not be consistent. However, this is not decisive evidence for OS benefit, given the analysis is ad hoc. We think this OS analysis plus the 2025 Sep. analysis will help with the BLA review rather than adding definitive statistical weight.
- **We also have a positive view of the trend of OS HR becoming lower with longer follow-up in HARMONi,** which might suggest ivonescimab's OS benefit is similar to PD-1 mAb, continuing to improve with longer follow-up time. More specifically, in the ITT population, OS HR is 0.79/0.78/0.76 in 2025 Apr./2025 Sep./2026 Jun. analysis, respectively. Similarly, in the Western patient population, OS HR is 0.98/0.84/0.76 in 2025 Apr./2025 Sep./2026 Jun. analysis, respectively.
- **Read-through to HARMONi-3, which is the Ph3 trial investors care most about, is modestly positive with limited impact.** HARMONi-3 is the global 1L NSCLC study; squamous-cohort's final PFS is due in 2H26 with interim OS, and non-squamous PFS in 1H27. A consistent West-vs-Asia OS profile in HARMONi is comforting because HARMONi-3's success rests on replicating strong China data (HARMONi- 6 OS HR=0.66) in a Western-heavy population. Previously, we estimated that final PFS will hit, but the interim OS HR in HARMONi-3 needs to be around 0.72 to be statistically significant, which we believe is a high bar. But we think HARMONi-3 final OS will hit.
- **What to watch next — HARMONi-3 squamous cohort's final PFS and interim OS in 2H26 are the next key catalysts.** This is the next binary event and matters more than the 22 July OS update, since the earlier interim PFS analysis did not hit, leaving interim OS as the near-term signal on whether OS efficacy holds in a Western-heavy first line NSCLC population. Also on the calendar: the Nov 14, 2026 PDUFA decision for the 2L EGFRmut NSCLC

Overweight

9926.HK, 9926 HK
Price (22 Jul 26):HK\$98.90
Price Target (Dec-26):HK\$162.00

Healthcare

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indication, plus HARMONi-3 non-squamous PFS in 1H27.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Akeso (Overweight; Price Target: HK\$162.00)

Investment Thesis

Akeso is a commercial-stage biotech in China and a leader in bispecific antibody. Despite Akeso's solid stock performance in 2024, we continue to see upside to its share price in 2025, driven by: (1) AK104 (PD-1/CTLA-4): Indication expansion into a broad range of large markets in China, which we expect should generate ~Rmb7bn in China peak sales. (2) AK112 (PD-1/VEGF): Successful inclusion in the NRDL, which should unleash solid sales momentum with >Rmb8bn peak sales in NSCLC in China alone, and its leading position in the PD-(L)1/VEGF space, as well as a highly competitive efficacy profile vs. Keytruda should support ex-China peak sales of US\$6+bn.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of HK\$162 is based on our DCF valuation. We estimate free cash flow for Akeso until 2034, assuming a terminal growth rate of 3.0% and a WACC of 9.6%.

DCF valuation

WACC Assumptions	
Risk-free rate	3.8%
Market risk	6.6%
Beta	1.0
Cost of equity	10.4%
Cost of debt	3.0%
Liabilities as a % of EV	10%
WACC	9.6%

WACC	9.6%
Terminal growth rate	3.0%
Terminal Present Value	80,597
PV Cash Flow	35,486
Enterprise value	116,084
+ Cash balance	10,466
- LT Debt	(4,541)
- Minority Interest	(131)
Early pipeline assets	9,500
Akeso equity value (RMB mn)	131,640
+ SMMT equity value (Rmb mn)	3,911
Total equity value (Rmb mn)	135,551
Shares Outstanding (MM)	921
Per Share Value (RMB)	147.2
Per Share Value (HKD)	162

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Key downside risks include: (1) pipeline development setbacks; and (2) sales of AK104 or AK112 are below our expectations.

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Akeso (9926.HK, 9926 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage May 27, 2020. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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